

What is Panasonic's strategy for promoting their LED drivers in India?

We will implement the following strategies so as to provide our customers not only LED drivers but other semiconductor products as well:

1. Strong relationships and partnerships with our Indian distributors and local entrepreneurs to directly cater to local needs.
2. Provide comprehensive technical support.
3. Provide total solutions to customers.
4. Shorten the time-to-market for customer.

What are the key things to look out for when deciding on LED driver solution?

Regardless of the target applications, a solution which maximises the power-efficiency is a good point to start. The solution should also be design-flexible such that it can be implemented in multiple LED lighting applications. This eases the design process and shortens the duration of design. From the view-point of reducing maintenance costs and improving the lifetime of LED lighting system, select solutions which have minimal parallel LED strings.

With Indian consumers preferring end-to-end and customised solutions, does Panasonic face any limitations?

Panasonic has no issues in providing end-to-end and customised solutions to customers. Although it is challenging for the local customers to source for the specific components in India, Panasonic is working to overcome this issue.

What are the unique features of Panasonic LED drivers as compared to other solutions available in the market?

Our 'multi-mode' LED driver AN30888A can be used from 1 watt to about 60-70 watt LED driver applications.

It can be configured in buck, boost or buck-boost modes as per customer's requirements. Customers do not have to source or stock multiple LED drivers for their different applications. By doing this they can bring down their sourcing and inventory costs. Moreover, with low number of external components the e-BOM cost of our solutions are among the most competitive in the market.

Our LED solutions offer low-cost advantage and ease of design, and our technical staff can provide strong support to achieve customers' design requirements.

What kind of challenges are you facing in India and how are you handling them?

The challenge that we face in India when selling the LED drivers is the huge volume of enquiries from various manufacturers with small production quantity. This can be labeled as 'high-mix, low-volume.'

Price has been a major hindrance for mass applications of LED lights. Do you see LED prices going down in the next two years?

With the increasing trend of LED luminaries for lighting in infrastructures, automotive and general-purpose use, the price of LED is forecast to drop in the coming years.

Where do you see Indian LED market five years down the line?

We expect the main cities to shift to LED lighting with the support from government. With the emphasis on being eco-friendly, we think that LED market in India has great potential, especially in the areas of general lights, street lights and other high-power industrial segments. In addition, India's automotive sector also has the potential for using LED lighting. ●

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